Nvidia investigates its CEO

Nvidia's CEO admitted an extramarital affair, and the board is investigating reports that the woman involved was a foreign intelligence target. Much of the story is still unproven.

Level 3 · B2 · 334 words · 15.9 words per sentence · 21 glossed

Jensen Huang, the CEO of Nvidia, a company worth about $4.5 trillion, admitted on Sunday, November 8, that he had an extramarital affair. In a letter to employees he said he had been unfaithful to his wife and apologized to his family. He did not name the other person.

On October 29, The New York Times reported that US officials had spent more than a year looking into Huang's close relationship with Alice Huang, who is not related to him. Reports link her to Megaspeed, a Singapore-based data center company that became one of Nvidia's largest customers, buying about $4.8 billion in equipment. Photos cited by CNN show the two together at events as early as 2024, but photos show association, not wrongdoing.

According to the reports, US intelligence officials suspect that she gathered information for Beijing. None of this has been proven in public, no charges have been reported, and there is no public evidence that Huang knowingly shared confidential information. China's foreign ministry calls the claims groundless, and Megaspeed denies wrongdoing. Singapore says it never described her as under investigation for intelligence links, although it is still looking into Megaspeed.

Nvidia's board has opened an independent investigation. It says it has no reason to believe that national security or company secrets were compromised, and Huang remains CEO. A proposed shareholder lawsuit claims that investors were misled, but no court has ruled on it.

President Trump called Huang an honorable person and said he had not heard that Huang had done anything wrong. Three Republican House chairmen asked Huang to appear on November 18, and Senator Elizabeth Warren, a Democrat, wants answers too. On Monday, Nvidia's shares fell more than 4 percent, erasing about $190 billion in market value.

The case reaches beyond one person's private life: Nvidia's chips are central to the AI industry, and Washington limits some sales to China. One analyst said the news would increase scrutiny of those sales, which Huang has pushed for. Nvidia reports results on November 17.

GLOSSARY

CEO	diretor-executivo
Nvidia	empresa americana que faz chips para inteligência artificial
extramarital affair	relação fora do casamento
unfaithful	infiel
looking into	investigando, examinando
wrongdoing	conduta ilegal ou errada
intelligence	inteligência, serviços de informação do governo
charges	acusações formais na Justiça
evidence	evidências, provas
knowingly	sabendo, de propósito
groundless	sem fundamento
investigation	investigação
board	conselho de administração
compromised	postos em risco
shareholder lawsuit	processo judicial movido por acionistas
misled	enganados
ruled on	decidido sobre
honorable	honrado
chairmen	presidentes de comissão

shares	ações
scrutiny	exame atento

KEY DATES

Oct 29	The New York Times reports on Huang's close relationship with a woman linked to Megaspeed.
Nov 5	Three Republican committee chairmen in the House ask Huang to appear before Congress.
Nov 8	Huang admits the affair in a letter to employees. The board opens an investigation.
Nov 9	Nvidia shares fall more than 4%.
Nov 17	Nvidia reports its quarterly results. SCHEDULED
Nov 18	The date Congress asked Huang to appear. REQUESTED

Sources: Al Jazeera, SiliconANGLE, Saudi Gazette, International Business Times UK. Dates in 2026.

What we know, and what we do not

Two stories run together here: a private one and a national-security one.
This table keeps them apart.

	CONFIRMED	NOT PROVEN, OR NOT KNOWN YET
HUANG	He admitted the affair in a letter to employees on November 8 and apologized.	Whether he knew about any spying. No public evidence shows that he did.
THE WOMAN	Alice Huang is not related to Jensen Huang. Reports link her to Megaspeed.	US officials reportedly suspect that she gathered information for China. No charges have been reported, and China calls the claim groundless.
MEGASPEED	A company based in Singapore. It bought about $4.8 billion in equipment from Nvidia. Singapore says its inquiries into the company continue.	Whether it broke export rules. Megaspeed denies any wrongdoing.
NVIDIA	The board opened an independent investigation. It says it has no reason to believe that secrets were compromised. Huang stays as CEO.	What the investigation will find. No results have been reported.
CONGRESS	Three Republican committee chairmen asked Huang to appear on November 18. Senator Elizabeth Warren, a Democrat, also wants answers.	Whether he will attend, and what he will say.
THE MARKET	Nvidia shares fell more than 4% on November 9, a loss of about $190 billion in value.	How investors will react to the company's results on November 17.

Sources: Al Jazeera, SiliconANGLE, International Business Times UK, Saudi Gazette. Situation on November 12, 2026.

WORDS IN THIS TABLE AND IN THE KEY DATES

appear before Congress comparecer perante o Congresso
admitted admitiu
spying espionagem
suspect suspeitam
inquiries investigações oficiais
export rules regras que limitam a venda de tecnologia a outros países
appear comparecer

AFTER READING

1. What did Jensen Huang admit, and what did the Nvidia board decide to do?
2. Why is this story about more than a private matter?
3. What has not been proven so far?

TALK ABOUT IT

4. At what point does a leader's private conduct become a matter of corporate governance? Does the size of the company matter?
5. Huang apologized in a letter without naming anyone. What makes a public apology credible, and what can undermine it?
6. This story mixes confirmed facts, official suspicion and denials. How can a reader tell them apart, and why does it matter?
7. Governments restrict some technology exports for security reasons. Where would you draw the line between security and free trade?

PRACTICE

SOURCES

Al Jazeera, US chipmaker Nvidia investigates CEO Jensen Huang over affair

SiliconANGLE, Despite spying scandal, Trump stands by Nvidia boss Jensen Huang

International Business Times UK, Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang Admits Affair as Board Investigates Whether He Was Targeted by Chinese Intelligence

Saudi Gazette, Nvidia chief Jensen Huang admits affair after tech giant opens probe into spy claims

HotHardware, NVIDIA's Jensen Huang Admits Affair As Board Probes China Spy Claims